

WhatsApp Lead CRM

Product Requirements Document — Current State & Build Plan

Prepared for: Novasie · Prepared: July 2026

Why This Document Exists

We want a CRM that captures leads from our Facebook/Instagram ads, lets the sales team manage them through a pipeline, lets us chat with customers on WhatsApp, and — eventually — automatically shows those customers new retargeting ads on Meta when they've gone cold. This document answers two questions in plain terms: what does our current codebase already do, and what is left to build to get to that full vision. Part 1 covers what exists today. Part 2 covers what still needs to be built, in a suggested order.

The Short Version

The foundation is in good shape. The system already pulls leads automatically from Facebook/Instagram ad forms, gives the sales team a real pipeline board, and provides a shared WhatsApp inbox for chatting with customers — all of that already works today, not just on paper.

Two things need to be fixed first, before anything else: today the CRM only auto-creates leads from Facebook's "fill out a form" ads — it does not yet auto-create a lead when someone clicks a Click-to-WhatsApp ad and messages us directly, which is the flow we actually rely on most. And there's no rule yet that keeps one WhatsApp number tied to exactly one lead record, so manual entry and automatic sync can end up creating duplicates. Beyond that, nothing in the product knows when a lead should be shown a retargeting ad, nothing automatically sends that lead back to Meta to trigger a campaign, and there's no way to message a large group of leads at once or on a schedule. That entire second half needs to be built new. The rest of this document breaks down exactly which pieces fall on which side of that line.

Part 1 — What We Already Have

Everything below is already in the codebase and working, not just planned. Where something is only half-built, it's marked "Partially built" and explained.

1. Getting Leads Into the System

How new leads arrive and get cleaned up. Two lead sources matter to us: Facebook/Instagram "fill out a form" ads (already working), and Facebook/Instagram "Click-to-WhatsApp" ads where the lead lands straight in a WhatsApp chat (not working yet) — plus manual entry by our own team.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Automatic lead capture from Facebook/Instagram lead forms	Ready to use	When someone fills out a lead form on a Facebook or Instagram ad, it's automatically pulled into the CRM every 5–15 minutes and turned into a lead record — no manual work needed.
Automatic lead creation from Click-to-WhatsApp ads	Not built yet	This is the flow we actually want most: someone clicks a Facebook/Instagram ad, it opens WhatsApp, and they send a first message. Today that message just arrives as an ordinary WhatsApp chat — the system does not recognize it came from an ad or automatically create a new lead for it. This needs to be built (see Milestone 1).
Duplicate lead prevention by WhatsApp number	Partially built	Leads coming from the Facebook form-sync are checked for duplicates. There is no rule yet that stops two lead records from being created with the same WhatsApp number — whether that's a manual entry duplicating a synced lead, or two manual entries. WhatsApp number needs to become a strict unique field (see Milestone 1).
Manually add a lead using a WhatsApp number	Partially built	Team members can add a lead today through the general new-lead form or a spreadsheet upload, but there's no quick, purpose-built "enter a WhatsApp number, we check it doesn't already exist, then create the lead" action. This needs to be built as the standard manual entry point (see Milestone 1).
Import leads from a spreadsheet (CSV)	Ready to use	Anyone can upload a spreadsheet of leads and have them added to the system.
Tagging a lead with its ad/campaign	Partially built	Only leads that came through the Facebook form-sync carry campaign info today. There's no general "which campaign did this come from" tag for leads added another way.

2. Managing Leads & Deals (Core CRM)

This is the most mature part of the product — production-ready, no real gaps.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Contact & lead records (name, phone, notes, custom fields)	Ready to use	Every lead has a full profile: contact details, source, status, industry, and any custom fields we choose to add.
Visual sales pipeline (drag-and-drop board)	Ready to use	Deals move through stages on a Kanban-style board, same idea as Trello.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Assigning leads/deals to team members	Ready to use	Leads can be assigned manually, or automatically based on rules (e.g. round-robin, territory).
One combined activity feed per lead	Ready to use	Calls, notes, tasks, WhatsApp messages, and status changes all show up in a single timeline for each lead or deal.
Search, filters, and saved views	Ready to use	Team members can filter, sort, and save their own custom views of the lead/deal lists.

3. WhatsApp Messaging

The messaging engine itself is a separate, well-established WhatsApp tool that plugs into this CRM — it talks to Meta's official WhatsApp Business API, not a workaround or unofficial method, which matters for staying in Meta's good graces.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Two-way team inbox	Ready to use	Anyone on the team can see and reply to WhatsApp conversations tied to a lead or deal, in real time.
Sending photos, documents, and videos	Ready to use	Agents can attach and send media files directly in the chat.
Sending pre-approved message templates	Ready to use	Templates that Meta has approved can be sent to start a new conversation. Creating and submitting new templates for approval happens in a separate settings screen today, not fully inside the main CRM experience.
Sending free-text replies	Ready to use	Once a customer has messaged us, agents can reply freely without needing a template.
Interactive buttons / quick-reply lists in WhatsApp	Not built yet	The underlying WhatsApp tool supports these, but this CRM doesn't yet send or display them — customers can't tap a button, only read plain text.
Internal notes & multiple agents on one chat	Ready to use	Team members can leave notes only visible internally, and everyone assigned to a lead gets notified of new messages.

4. Sending Messages at Scale

Everything below this line does not exist yet — there is no bulk messaging or automation of any kind today.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Bulk broadcast to a list of contacts	Not built yet	There's no way today to send one message to many leads at once (e.g. "all leads from last month's campaign").
Scheduling a message for later	Not built yet	No option to write a message now and have it go out at a future date/time.
Recurring / drip messages	Not built yet	No multi-step "day 1, day 3, day 7" follow-up sequences.
Auto-reply or simple chatbot	Not built yet	No automatic response to common questions when nobody's available.
Behind-the-scenes task	Ready to use	The system already has a reliable internal

Feature	Status	What this means today
scheduler		clock/scheduler running jobs automatically (it's what powers the Facebook lead sync every few minutes) — this is the plumbing that every feature above would be built on top of, and it's already proven to work.

5. Notifications & Alerts

Feature	Status	What this means today
Alert when you're assigned a lead or mentioned	Ready to use	Team members get notified the moment a lead is assigned to them, or someone mentions them in a comment.
Alert the moment a brand-new lead arrives	Partially built	This only fires today if the lead already has an owner set when it's created. A fresh, unassigned lead (like one just synced from Facebook) doesn't alert anyone until someone manually assigns it.
Alert when a lead has gone quiet for X days	Not built yet	Nothing today watches for leads that haven't been responded to and reminds the team to follow up.

6. Retargeting Reminders

This entire area is new — none of it exists in the product today.

Feature	Status	What this means today
A "due for retargeting on this date" field on each lead	Not built yet	No such concept exists anywhere in the data model yet.
A dashboard of who's due for retargeting	Not built yet	No view shows which leads or groups of leads are coming due.
An automatic reminder when the date arrives	Not built yet	Nothing to trigger this reminder from, since the date field above doesn't exist yet.

7. Automatically Retargeting Leads on Meta

This is the most Meta-specific, and most unbuilt, part of the product. None of it exists today.

Feature	Status	What this means today
Connecting to Meta's ad-campaign tools (Marketing API)	Not built yet	The system today only reads incoming lead forms — it has no connection at all to Meta's campaign/audience management tools.
Automatically adding due leads into a Meta retargeting audience	Not built yet	No mechanism exists to push a list of leads to Meta as a "Custom Audience" for ad targeting.
Automatically turning on/adjusting a retargeting campaign	Not built yet	No trigger exists that changes a Meta campaign's status or budget based on CRM activity.
Sending conversion events back to Meta (Conversions API)	Not built yet	No server-side event tracking is sent to Meta to help their ad algorithm learn from our sales outcomes.

Feature	Status	What this means today
A record of what was pushed to Meta and when	Not built yet	No audit trail exists for this, since none of the pushes above exist yet either.

8. Admin, Security & Reporting

Feature	Status	What this means today
Role-based permissions (who can see/do what)	Ready to use	Different roles (e.g. sales rep vs. manager) see different data and have different permissions, including a sales-hierarchy-aware view for managers.
Dashboards & reporting (leads by source, deals by stage, win rate)	Ready to use	A manager dashboard already shows leads by source, deals by stage, conversion funnels, and win/loss reasons.
Exporting data	Ready to use	Standard export to spreadsheet is available on lead and deal lists.
Keeping API keys and passwords safe	Partially built	Most credentials (Twilio, Exotel, WhatsApp) are stored encrypted, as they should be. One exception was found: the Facebook "page access token" is currently stored as plain, unencrypted text rather than encrypted like everything else — a quick fix, but worth doing before this goes further.
Verifying that incoming requests are really from Meta/Exotel	Partially built	The Exotel (calling) integration uses a weaker check than it should (a shared static code in a web link, rather than a proper cryptographic signature) — the code itself even flags this as a known workaround. The WhatsApp connection itself lives in a separate tool outside this codebase, so its verification needs to be checked there directly.

Part 2 — What We Need to Build

The items below are grouped into three milestones. Each milestone only depends on work finished in an earlier one — most importantly, we can't automatically retarget a lead on Meta until we know which ad sent them and when they're due, so that comes first. Two "nice to have" items are pushed to the end since they're the biggest investments and the least urgent.

Milestone 1 — Know Where Every Lead Came From

Estimated time: about 1.5–2 weeks. Goal: every lead is properly attributed to its source, WhatsApp number is a clean unique identifier, and we know when a lead is due for a follow-up ad.

- Make WhatsApp number a required, unique field on every lead — block creating a second lead with a number that already exists, whether it comes in manually, via CSV, or via Facebook sync. (Existing data will need a one-time cleanup pass to merge any duplicates that already exist before this rule can be turned on.)
- Build a simple "Add Lead" action for the team: type in a WhatsApp number (and name), the system checks whether that number already exists, and either opens the existing lead or creates a new one — this becomes the standard manual entry point instead of the generic new-record form.
- Automatically create a new lead the moment someone messages in via a Click-to-WhatsApp ad, using their WhatsApp number as the unique identifier and tagging which ad/campaign sent them (the biggest single item in this milestone — needs coordination with the WhatsApp messaging tool, since that's where the incoming message and ad information first arrive).
- Add general campaign/ad tags to leads, not just Facebook-form-sourced ones.
- Alert the team the moment ANY new lead arrives, not only ones that are already assigned.
- Quick security fixes: encrypt the one exposed Facebook token, and strengthen the weak webhook check.
- Add the "next retarget date" to each lead, plus the logic that decides when it should be set.

Milestone 2 — See and Message Who's Due

Estimated time: about 1.5–2 weeks. Goal: the team can see who needs re-engaging and can actually message them, even before Meta automation exists.

- Build a dashboard showing which leads/groups are due for retargeting.
- Add an automatic reminder when someone becomes due.
- Turn on interactive WhatsApp buttons and quick-reply lists.
- Build bulk broadcast messaging to a chosen list of contacts.
- Add scheduling — send a message later, or set up a recurring send.

Milestone 3 — Automatic Meta Retargeting

Estimated time: about 2–2.5 weeks. Goal: the system runs the ad-retargeting cycle largely on its own — this is the actual finish line for the original vision.

- Connect the CRM to Meta's ad-campaign tools (Marketing API).
- Automatically push due leads into a Meta retargeting audience.
- Log every push to Meta, so there's a clear audit trail.
- Add the "lead has gone quiet" notification.
- Stretch goals if time allows: auto-adjust campaign budgets/status, and send conversion events back to Meta.

Later / Nice-to-Have (not urgent)

- Multi-step drip/follow-up sequences.
- Auto-reply or simple chatbot for common questions.
- A no-code "if this happens, do that" automation builder — this is the single biggest investment on the list, and it's smarter to build it after we've seen how the simpler features above actually get used day to day.

Total Estimate

Roughly 13–14 weeks of work for one developer if done in order. If two people work in parallel — one on messaging/automation, one on the Meta ads integration — this could compress to about 7–9 weeks.